

**"ALL ANIMALS ARE  
EQUAL, BUT SOME  
ANIMALS ARE MORE  
EQUAL THAN OTHERS."**

George Orwell (1903–1950),  
English author, from his book  
*Animal Farm*



## SHARED PROFITS

It is difficult enough to get a level of equality in one nation, let alone worldwide. German philosopher Karl Marx (1818–1883) attempted to solve this problem by devising a theory for equality. Instead of many companies owned by different people living in the country, the ruling government would own all of the factories and evenly distribute profits among the workers so that it didn't all go to the owner. He believed that this would get rid of "classes" of people and create equality. From this idea, communism was born. It uses the same principles that Marx proposed. Communist states own all of the property and, in theory, share the general wealth. Each person is paid according to their abilities and needs. Communist countries today include China, Cuba, and Vietnam.



## PERSONAL GAINS

In contrast with communist states, capitalist societies promote the acquisition of wealth, and everyone, in theory, has the chance to become rich and powerful. Whether someone is born into a rich family or becomes rich and influential from setting up a business or becoming a media star, capitalism encourages people to seek personal gain. People can choose to spend their money on whatever they like, and the money spent often provides work for others. However, the worry is that those who are born into a life of privilege may continue to enjoy the best opportunities. As a result, the rich may get richer and the gap between rich and poor widens.



## COMMUNISM AND CAPITALISM

The communist idea of total equality is not supported by everyone. A concern is the level of control that communist governments have over people. Under communism, virtually everything is created and overseen by the government, from school textbooks to newspapers and television programs. Also, those in power often enjoy privileges not available to the masses. Capitalism can be highly unequal. A class society can develop, with some seeing their fortunes expand and others surviving on the bare minimum. Criminal underclasses may flourish as people find alternative ways to "get rich quick."

